



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Restoration Academy

School Website: <https://www.restorationacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Restoration Academy, Alabama 35064, presents a notably religious, virtue-formation-driven model of schooling with a strong emphasis on Christ-centered education, virtue formation, and community involvement. The public materials reviewed reveal a cohesive alignment with several classical education sensibilities (notably: formation of character, memory-based pedagogy, and explicit parental partnership). However, the curriculum responsiveness to the canonical classical triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the explicit Great Books / Great Conversation components are not clearly foregrounded in the RA public materials. Taken together, the school demonstrates substantial classical-influenced aspects—especially in its character formation, liturgical/communal emphasis, and emphasis on vocations and virtue—while not fully meeting all core classical criteria (notably the explicit Great Books / trivium emphasis in curriculum). Overall, Restorations Academy is CLASSICAL with meaningful, category-specific strengths and a few gaps that prevent it from achieving a full, textbook “classical” classification in every category.

ExecutiveSummary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on scoring approach

- The categorization draws on a classical rubric that privileges explicit religious/theological grounding, formation of virtue, and a distinctive classical pedagogy (including contemplative/restful learning, memorization/recitation, and Socratic-style inquiry in more mature settings). Positive keywords from the classical lexicon (as compiled in the Six Essential Elements documents) were identified within RA's public materials (e.g., Christ-centered theology, virtue formation, contemplation/wonder, memory-based pedagogy, parental partnership, and living-curriculum cues). Where RA's curriculum centers on biblical/theological content rather than Great Books or the explicit Trivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the public materials, the category scored lower toward NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. See the Evidence and Keyword Analysis sections for specifics and excerpts. The classical-keyword framework and indicators are drawn from the knowledge-base materials “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)” and related lexicon documents.

What would move the needle (only relevant if classified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Strengthen explicit Great Books/Great Conversation articulation in the Curriculum category (e.g., situate Great Books as core reading with a Great Conversation framing).

- Make explicit the grammar-logic-rhetoric progression in the public-facing Curriculum documents (and show progression in K–12).
- Emphasize a more explicit use of Socratic seminars or dialectic in upper grades as a visible pedagogy across more departments.
- Increase explicit articulation of a “living curriculum” with a teacher-mentor as the “living curriculum” model in public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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